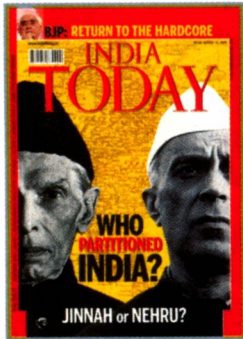


Who Partitioned India?

AUGUST 31, 2009

It is the stain on our freedom and the scar on our memory as a nation.
A journey in history to uncover the masterminds of Partition.



“We don’t know who was responsible for the partition of India. The saddest part is that politicians continue to reap the benefits of Partition while the general public suffers.”

RAVINDRA MISRA, *Delhi*

Painful History

Instead of debating Jinnah’s ‘secular credentials’, we must evaluate the threat to our secular democracy from the resurgent Islamic orthodoxy in Jinnah’s Pakistan (“Who Partitioned India?”, August 31). The furore over the book, the ban imposed by the Gujarat Government and, not the least, Jaswant Singh’s expulsion will be received as evidence that India remains congenitally allergic to the idea of Pakistan and that sections of its political establishment will never be able to come to terms with Pakistan’s existence. The corollary: peace with India is not possible.

MEGHANA M., *United Kingdom*

In the cover story, it has been rightly analysed that



A House Divided

For the BJP, episodes like Vasundhara Raje’s refusal to step down from the post of Leader of the Opposition in the Rajasthan Assembly and the expulsion of Jaswant Singh were indeed unfortunate (“Return to the Hardcore”, August 31). The party must repair the damage now. This is essential not only for the party but also for the nation since the BJP is the only credible alternative to the Congress, irrespective of imaginary apprehensions from so-called secular elements.

V.S. GANESHAN, *Bangalore*

It has become a fashion in the BJP to create controversies deliberately to be in the news. It is time that like-minded parties came together under the undisputed leadership of a charismatic personality like Sonia Gandhi in the Congress, whose word would be the last in all controversies and differences within the group.

S.C. AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

our freedom to make history a permanent site of dispute has brought Partition back to the headlines and the provocateur this time is Jaswant Singh, who in his book *Jinnah: India-Partition-Independence* not only challenges the conventional wisdom on the division of India but commits the blasphemy of demythifying national heroes like Jawaharlal Nehru and Sardar Patel. Jaswant could well have left the business of writing history to historians, and the BJP could have taken a somewhat indulgent view of his trespass.

DILBAG RAI, *Chandigarh*

Penny Wise

It is surprising that women who are very much living with their spouses are logged as

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